

Sentiment Journey Diary

System Spec & Data Schema · v1.0 · May 2026

1 · What This Artifact Is

The Sentiment Journey Diary is a data-driven emotional tracking system for the PMD project journey. It captures quantitative confidence ratings alongside rich qualitative retrospective content for every project — then generates dynamic visual infographics from that data on demand.

The core output is a horizontal hiker-on-a-path infographic: a small village at the left (P0 origin), a distant mountain summit at the right (long-term vision), and an emotional terrain between them showing peaks and valleys mapped to real project outcomes. The path scales dynamically — narrow views focus on 3–5 current projects with full detail, wide macro views show the complete arc with summary-level content.

The infographic serves multiple output contexts: thepmddev.com homepage feature, branded blog post hero banners, social post assets, and — in a later phase — an embedded interactive React component on a dedicated Journey page.

2 · Two-Layer Architecture

Layer	File	Purpose	Grows over time?
Data source	<code>PMD_Sentiment_Data.json</code>	Structured log of every project entry — ratings, retro bullets, metadata	Yes — one entry added per project close
Generator	<code>generate_sentiment_infographic.py</code>	Reads the JSON, renders the infographic at requested zoom level, outputs PDF + PNG	No — script is stable, re-run on demand

The data source and the generator are intentionally separate. The JSON grows with every project. The generator is stateless — it reads whatever entries exist and renders the requested view. Re-running the generator at any time produces an updated infographic without modifying historical data.

3 · PMD_Sentiment_Data.json — Complete Schema

All cells wrapped in Paragraph objects per locked PDF pattern. The JSON schema below defines every field, its type, and its purpose.

Field	Type	Required	Description
schema_version	string	Yes	Schema version identifier — e.g. '1.0'. Increment when fields are added.

generated	string	Yes	ISO 8601 timestamp of last data update — e.g. '2026-05-01'.
journey.origin	string	Yes	Label for the starting point of the path — e.g. 'P0 · Portfolio Shell'.
journey.destination	string	Yes	Label for the distant summit — e.g. 'Full-Stack PM · Hired'.
projects[]	array	Yes	Ordered array of project entries. One object per project, in completion order.
projects[].id	string	Yes	Unique project identifier — e.g. 'P0', 'P1', 'P2'.
projects[].name	string	Yes	Short display name — e.g. 'Portfolio Shell'.
projects[].phase_range	string	Yes	Phase span completed — e.g. 'Phases 1–9'.
projects[].completed	string	Yes	Completion date — e.g. 'May 2026'. Month + year is sufficient.
projects[].classification	string	Yes	'portfolio' or 'learning'. Locked at kickoff Step 3.
projects[].confidence_score	number	Yes	Honest post-project confidence score — 0.0 to 10.0. This is the elevation driver for the path.
projects[].peak_valley	string	Yes	'peak', 'valley', or 'neutral'. Used for path terrain rendering and avatar positioning.
projects[].headline	string	Yes	One-line emotional headline for this project — displayed on the infographic path node.
projects[].worked_well[]	string[]	Yes	Bullet array — what worked well. 2–4 items. Source: retrospective.
projects[].tricky[]	string[]	Yes	Bullet array — what was tricky or harder than expected. 2–3 items.
projects[].proud_of[]	string[]	Yes	Bullet array — what you are most proud of. 1–3 items.
projects[].exceeded_expectations[]	string[]	Yes	Bullet array — where output or growth exceeded your own expectations. 1–2 items.
projects[].fell_short[]	string[]	Yes	Bullet array — where you fell short of your own expectations. Honest. 1–2 items.
projects[].showcase_candidate	boolean	Yes	true / false — is this project a thepmdv.com showcase candidate?
projects[].showcase_rationale	string	Yes	One sentence — why it is or is not a showcase candidate.

projects[].skills_gained[]	string[]	Yes	Array of discrete skills gained or materially strengthened this project.
projects[].tools_used[]	string[]	Yes	Array of tools used — e.g. 'ReportLab', 'React', 'GA4'.
projects[].content_log_items[]	string[]	No	Optional array of Tier-1 content atoms captured this project — for content strategy cross-reference.
projects[].next_project_intent	string	No	One sentence describing the intended next project at the time of this entry. Captures forward thinking.

4 • Example Entry — P0 Seed Record

The JSON file is seeded with P0 at first creation. Every project close adds one entry. The structure below is the complete P0 seed — replace placeholder values with actuals when populating PMD_Sentiment_Data.json.

```
{
  "schema_version": "1.0",
  "generated": "2026-05-01",
  "journey": {
    "origin": "P0 • Portfolio Shell",
    "destination": "Full-Stack PM • Hired"
  },
  "projects": [
    {
      "id": "P0",
      "name": "Portfolio Shell",
      "phase_range": "Phases 1-9",
      "completed": "May 2026",
      "classification": "portfolio",
      "confidence_score": 1.0,
      "peak_valley": "neutral",
      "headline": "System exists. First product shipped. The path begins.",
      "worked_well": [
        "PMD system held structure across all 9 phases without breaking down",
        "WCAG 2.2 AA delivered non-negotiably – no deferred accessibility",
        "Session summaries enabled clean context handoff every session"
      ],
      "tricky": [
        "Sketch image positioning required many iteration cycles",
        "Responsive CSS took longer than estimated"
      ],
      "proud_of": [
        "Shipped a live URL – thepmdev.com – from a standing start",
        "16 approved artifacts across 9 phases – complete product cycle"
      ],
      "exceeded_expectations": [
        "PMD SKILL.md created – system now self-documenting and portable"
      ]
    }
  ]
}
```

```

],
"fell_short": [
"Draft-first protocol not active at P0 – coach led rather than user"
],
"showcase_candidate": true,
"showcase_rationale": "Demonstrates complete 9-phase process and live deployment.",
"skills_gained": ["ReportLab PDF generation", "WCAG 2.2 AA", "CI/CD via Netlify"],
"tools_used": ["HTML/CSS/JS", "ReportLab", "GA4", "Microsoft Clarity", "Netlify"],
"content_log_items": ["P0 launch build log – X.com pinned post"],
"next_project_intent": "P1 – TBD after six system additions complete"
}
]
}

```

5 · Infographic Visual Specification

5.1 · Layout — Horizontal Hiker Path

The infographic is horizontal landscape orientation. Left anchor: small village in foothills — labeled with `journey.origin`. Right anchor: distant mountain summit — labeled with `journey.destination`. Between them: a winding path whose elevation is driven by each project's `confidence_score`. Higher score = path rises. Lower score = path dips. The hiker avatar sits at the most recent project node.

5.2 · Zoom Levels — Two Output Modes

Mode	Projects shown	Detail level	Primary use case
Narrow · Current State	Previous 3–5 projects + next 1–2 projected	Full retro bullets visible at each node. Headline + worked well + tricky + proud of.	Homepage feature · Blog hero banner · Social post asset
Wide · Macro Arc	All projects from P0 forward	Headline only at each node. Confidence score visible. Full terrain arc readable.	Phase group retrospective · Executive Case Study visual · Journey page

5.3 · Path Node Anatomy

Element	Source field	Rendered as
Node marker	<code>peak_valley</code>	Circle — green for peak · amber for neutral · muted red for valley
Project label	<code>id + name</code>	'P1 · Project Name' — above or below node depending on path elevation
Emotional headline	<code>headline</code>	Italic caption beneath project label

Confidence score	confidence_score	Small badge — e.g. '1.0 / 10' — visible in both zoom modes
Retro bullets	worked_well · tricky · proud_of	Compact bullet list at node — narrow mode only
Portfolio star	showcase_candidate	★ marker on node when true

6 · Output Files — Naming Convention

File	Format	Purpose
PMD_SentimentJourney_Narrow_vX.X.pdf	PDF	Print-quality narrow view. Source for PNG export.
PMD_SentimentJourney_Narrow_vX.X.png	PNG	Web asset · blog hero banner · social post · homepage feature
PMD_SentimentJourney_Wide_vX.X.pdf	PDF	Print-quality macro arc view. Archive and case study attachment.
PMD_SentimentJourney_Wide_vX.X.png	PNG	Web asset for journey page and retrospective posts
PMD_Sentiment_Data.json	JSON	Permanent data source. Lives at repo root. Never deleted.
generate_sentiment_infographic.py	Python	Generator script. Reads JSON. Accepts --mode narrow wide --version flags.

7 · React Interactive Component — Scoped for Later

An interactive React version of the Sentiment Journey Diary is scoped but not yet built. It reads from the same PMD_Sentiment_Data.json data source. No new data entry is required when the component is eventually built — the JSON is the single source of truth for both outputs.

Feature	Description	Priority
Zoom slider	Toggle between narrow current-state view and wide macro arc	P0 v2 build
Node hover / tap	Expand full retro content for any project node on interaction	P0 v2 build
Live data binding	Reads PMD_Sentiment_Data.json directly — updates automatically when new entries are added	P0 v2 build

Export trigger	Button to trigger PDF/PNG snapshot generation from current view state	Later
Journey page embed	Component embedded on dedicated thepmdev.com/journey page	P0 v2 build

8 · Process — When and How to Update

Trigger	Action	Who
Project close — every project P0 through Pn	Add one entry to PMD_Sentiment_Data.json. Complete all required fields. Commit to repo.	PM Dev + Coach
Infographic needed for web or social use	Run generate_sentiment_infographic.py with --mode narrow. Output PNG to assets/.	PM Dev
Phase group retrospective	Run generator with --mode wide. Attach PDF to retrospective artifact.	PM Dev + Coach
Schema change required	Update schema_version in JSON. Document field addition in PMD_DECISION_LOG.md. Update this spec to match.	Coach
React component build triggered	Reference this spec Section 7 and PMD_Sentiment_Data.json schema. No data migration required.	PM Dev

9 · Locked Decisions

Decision	Detail
Data format	JSON — best tool for structured, extensible, machine-readable data. Not .md for convenience.
Numeric rating retained	confidence_score 0.0–10.0 kept as quantitative backbone. Boring in isolation. Powerful with qualitative context.
PDF priority over React	PDF/PNG snapshots built first — immediate use cases for web, social, blog. React component scoped and preserved for later.
Single data source	PMD_Sentiment_Data.json drives both PDF generator and future React component. No duplication.
Permanent retention	Every entry retained permanently. No overwriting historical data. Wide view depends on complete history.
P() helper — all table cells	Per locked PDF pattern. All table cell content wrapped in Paragraph. VALIGN TOP. Never plain strings.

Version History

Version	Key change	Date
v1.0	Initial spec — system architecture, full JSON schema, infographic spec, zoom levels, output naming, React scope, process triggers	May 2026